As mentioned above, binary-to-text encodings are supported. However, these are flagged as deprecated in the latest `mbstring` source code https://github.com/php/php-src/blob/php-8.4.0beta4/ext/mbstring/mbstring.c#L256 and should not be used with general-purpose `mbstring` functions (some have specialized `mbstring` functions, which are fine to use). The table below lists the deprecations and alternative handlers.

Table 8-23. *Deprecated encoding aliases and alternatives*

Encoding	Alternative
Base64	`base64_encode()`, `base64_decode()`
QPrint	`quoted_printable_encode`, `quoted_printable_decode()`
HTML Entities	`htmlspecialchars()`, `htmlentities()` `mb_encode_numericentity()`, `mb_decode_numericentity()`
Uuencode	`convert_uuencode()`, `convert_uudecode()`

`mb_internal_encoding()`

To get or set the internal encoding of `mbstring`, use the function `mb_internal_encoding()`. You'll likely never need to use the function unless maintaining *seriously* old systems: UTF-8 is fairly ubiquitous these days (as it should be). Nevertheless, here's how to use it:

```
print mb_internal_encoding() . PHP_EOL;
var_dump(mb_internal_encoding('UTF-16BE')) . PHP_EOL;
print mb_internal_encoding();
```

```
Output:
UTF-8
bool(true)
UTF-16BE
```

This setting will affect how `mbstring` treats string data by default and impacts input and output. Here's a quick and simple demo of what I mean:

```
$rawUTF16BE = "\x00\x48\x00\x65\x00\x6C\x00\x6C\x00\x6F";

print mb_internal_encoding() . PHP_EOL;
print bin2hex(mb_convert_encoding($rawUTF16BE, to_encoding: 'UTF-8')) .
PHP_EOL;
```